Setting Up Visual Studio Code and Codex on Mac: A Step-by-Step Guide

This section provides a complete walkthrough for installing and configuring Visual Studio Code on macOS, from downloading the installer to opening your first project.

Step 1: System Requirements

VS Code runs on macOS 10.15 (Catalina) or later, on both Intel and Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3/M4) Macs. Before you begin, verify your macOS version:

- Click the **Apple menu** (top-left corner) and select **About This Mac**.





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Step 2: Download VS Code

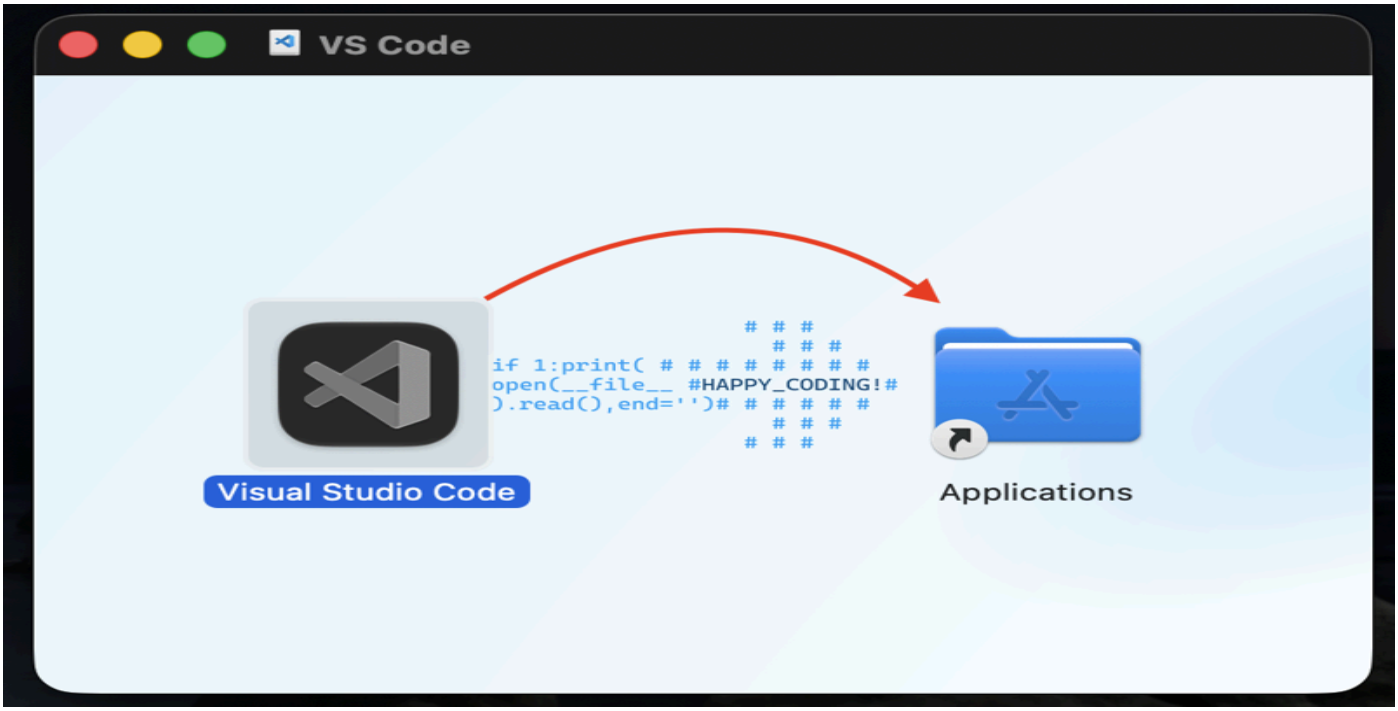
1. Open your browser and navigate to the official download page: `https://code.visualstudio.com/download`
2. Click the **Mac** download button. The site auto-detects whether you need the Intel or Apple Silicon (Universal) build. Both architectures are supported by the Universal binary.
3. Wait for the file to download. It arrives as a **.zip** archive (e.g., `VSCode-darwin-universal.zip`).



Step 3: Install VS Code

1. Open **Finder** and navigate to the **Downloads** folder.
2. Double-click the downloaded **.zip** file to extract it. This creates **Visual Studio Code.app**.
3. Drag **Visual Studio Code.app** into your **Applications** folder.
4. Open VS Code from **Applications**, or use Spotlight: press **Cmd + Space** and type **Visual Studio Code**.

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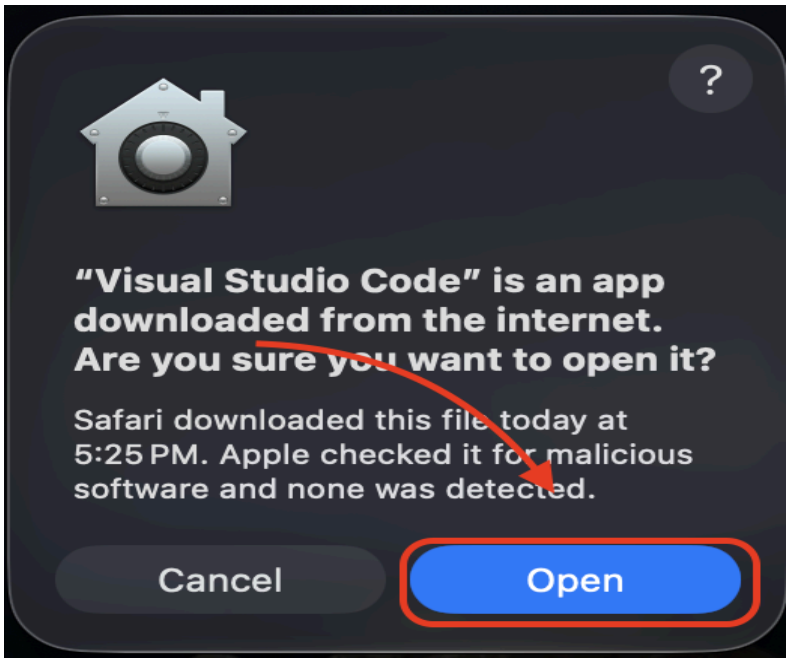




WARNING

On first launch, macOS Gatekeeper may display: "Visual Studio Code was downloaded from the Internet." Click Open to confirm. This is expected behavior for apps downloaded from the web — not a security risk.

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Step 4 : Install Essential Extensions

Open the Extensions panel with **Cmd + Shift + X**, then search for and install the following recommended extensions:

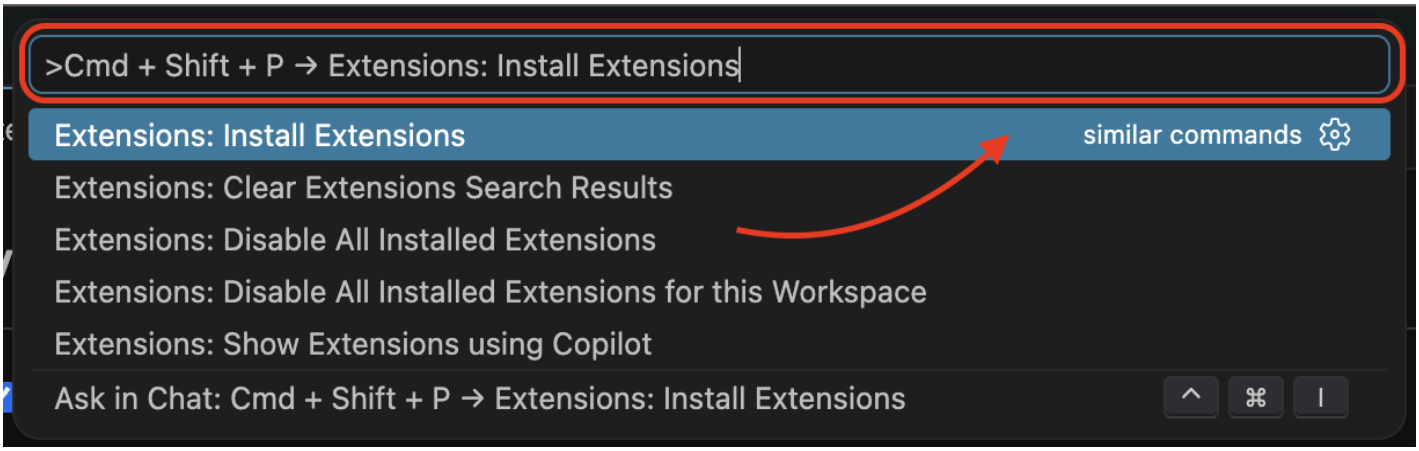


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Extension	Purpose
Python Language Support	Adds features like syntax highlighting, code completion to help you write Python code efficiently.
Python Language Debugger	Allows you to set breakpoints, inspect variables, and step through code to identify and fix errors.

You can also install extensions directly from the Command Palette:

```
Cmd + Shift + P  ->  Extensions: Install Extensions
```



Step 6: Installing Python on macOS

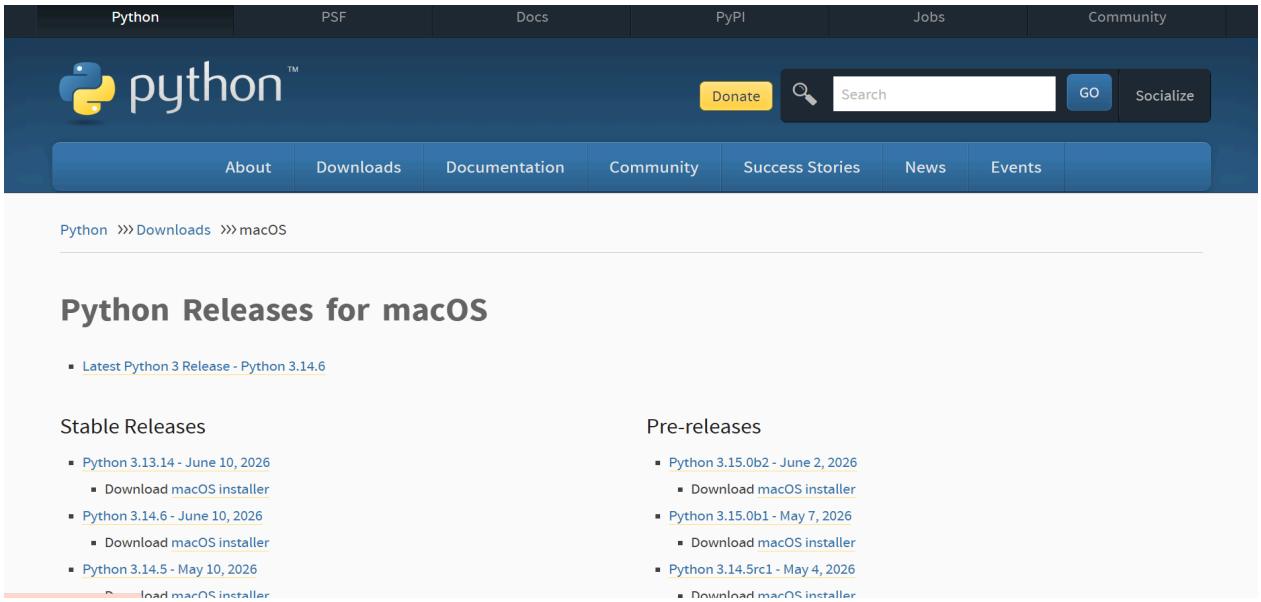
To open a project folder in VS Code from Terminal, navigate to the folder and run:

Step 6.1: Download Python:

1. Open your web browser (Safari, Chrome, etc.).
2. Go to: [Python Downloads Page]

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3. Click the stable **Python 3.13.14** installer from stable releases for macOS (for example, **macOS 64-bit universal installer**).

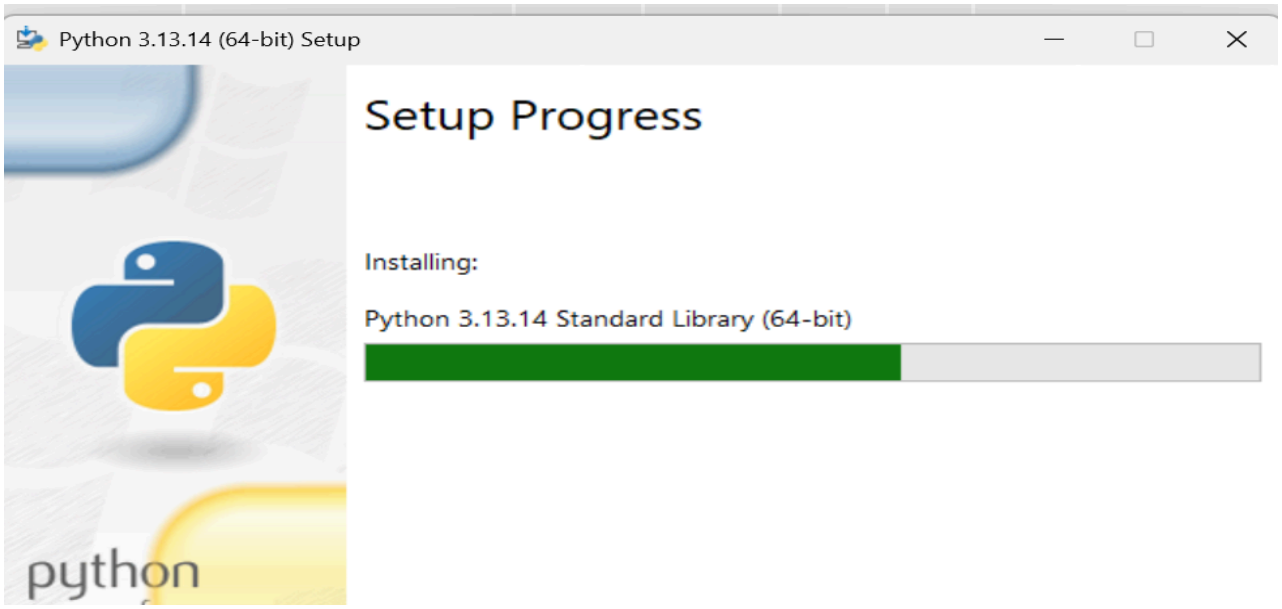


Step 6.2: Open the Installer

1. Once the download is complete, open the Downloads folder.
2. Double-click the downloaded `.pkg` file (for example, `python-3.x.x-macos11.pkg`).

Step 6.3: Complete the Installation

1. The Python installer wizard will open.
2. Click Continue on the introduction screen.
3. Review and accept the license agreement.
4. Click Install.
5. Enter your Mac password if prompted.



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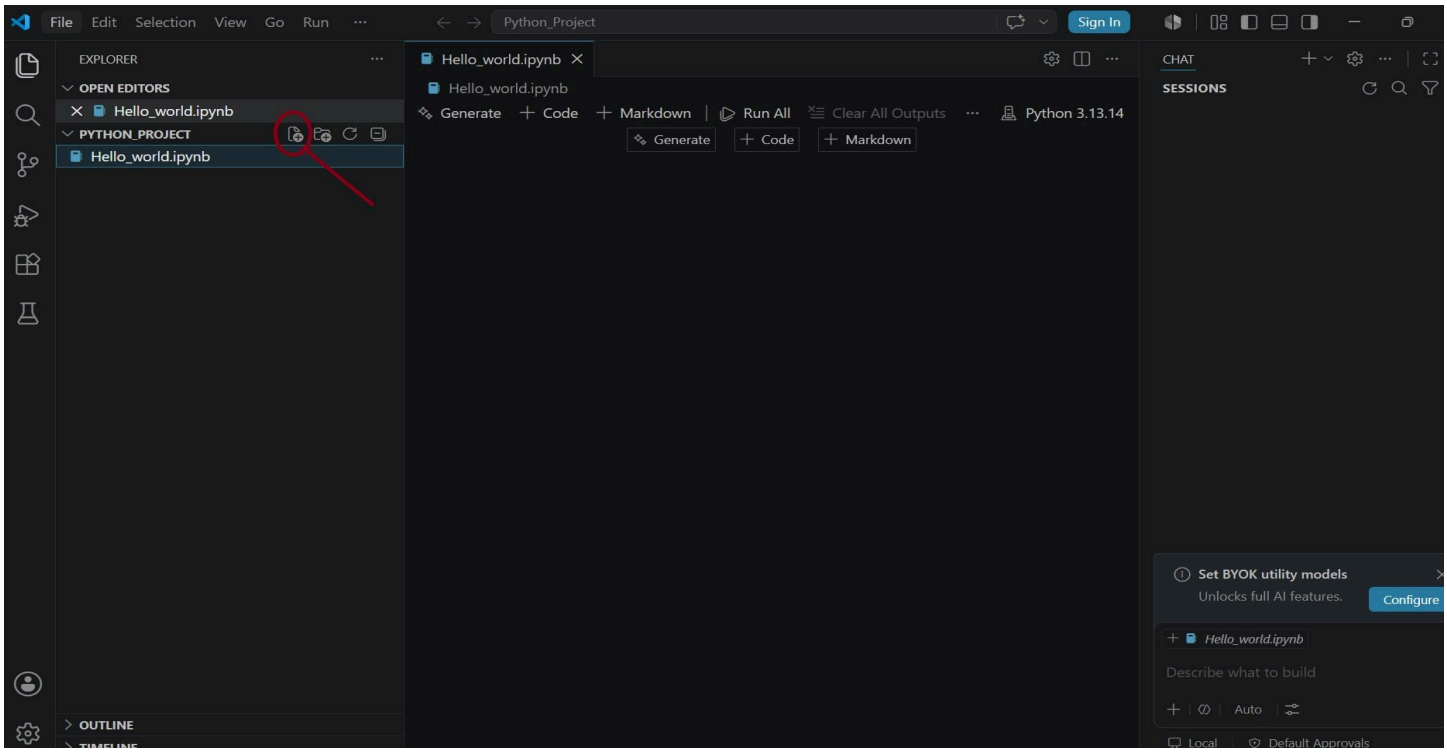
6. Wait for the installation to finish.
7. Click Close when the installation is complete.

Step 7: Selecting your kernel and creating the first project

To open a project folder in VS Code from Terminal, navigate to the folder and run:

Once Visual Studio Code is open, follow these steps to open your first project:

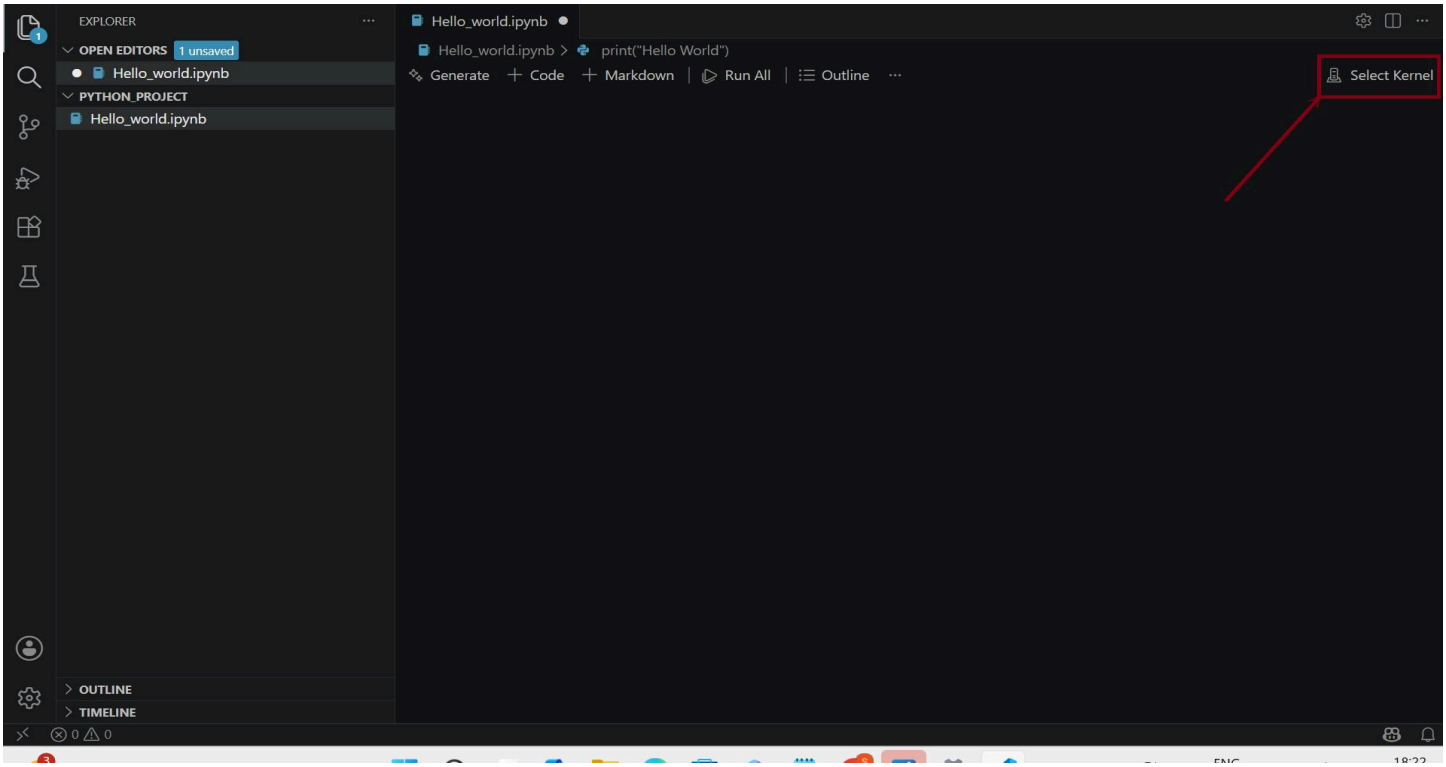
1. Create a Folder with title “PYTHON_PROJECT” on your local system
2. Open Visual Studio Code
3. In VS Code, click **File** in the top menu bar
4. Select **Open Folder**
5. Browse to the location where your “PYTHON_PROJECT” folder is created and saved.
6. Select the folder you want to work on.
7. Click **Open**.
8. If prompted with **"Do you trust the authors of the files in this folder?"**, click **Trust** if the folder is your own project or from a trusted source.
9. You will have the following view below:



10. Your project will now appear in the **Explorer** panel on the left side of VS Code. “Click on” the **File add icon near the “PYTHON_PROJECT” folder.**

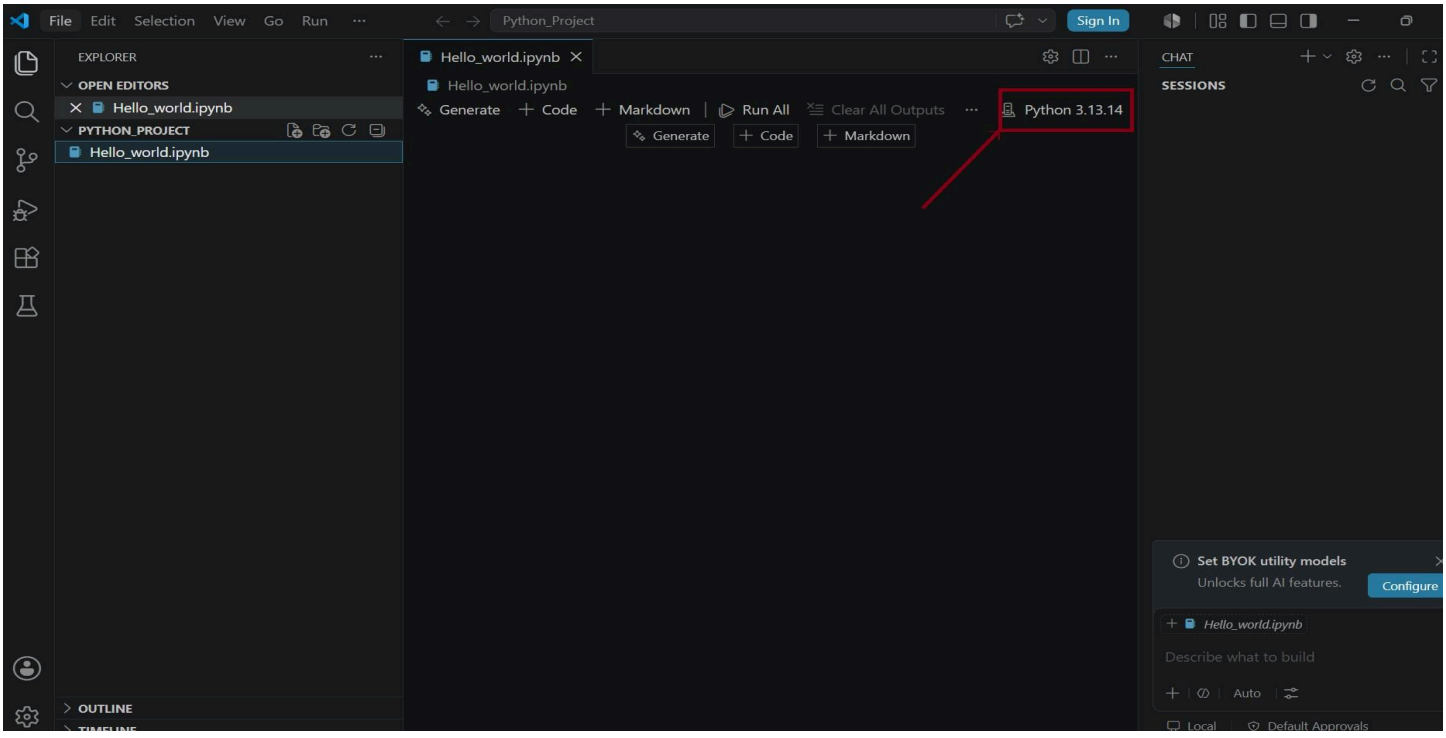
11. Create a python file titled **“Hello_World.ipynb”** and click on it. The following view will appear:

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12. Check the top-right **corner** of the notebook window as per the above view. Click **"Select Kernel"**. Choose one of the available Python environments.

13. Once you have selected the python environment, its name will appear .For example, since we have installed 3.13.14, it will appear instead of the kernel.

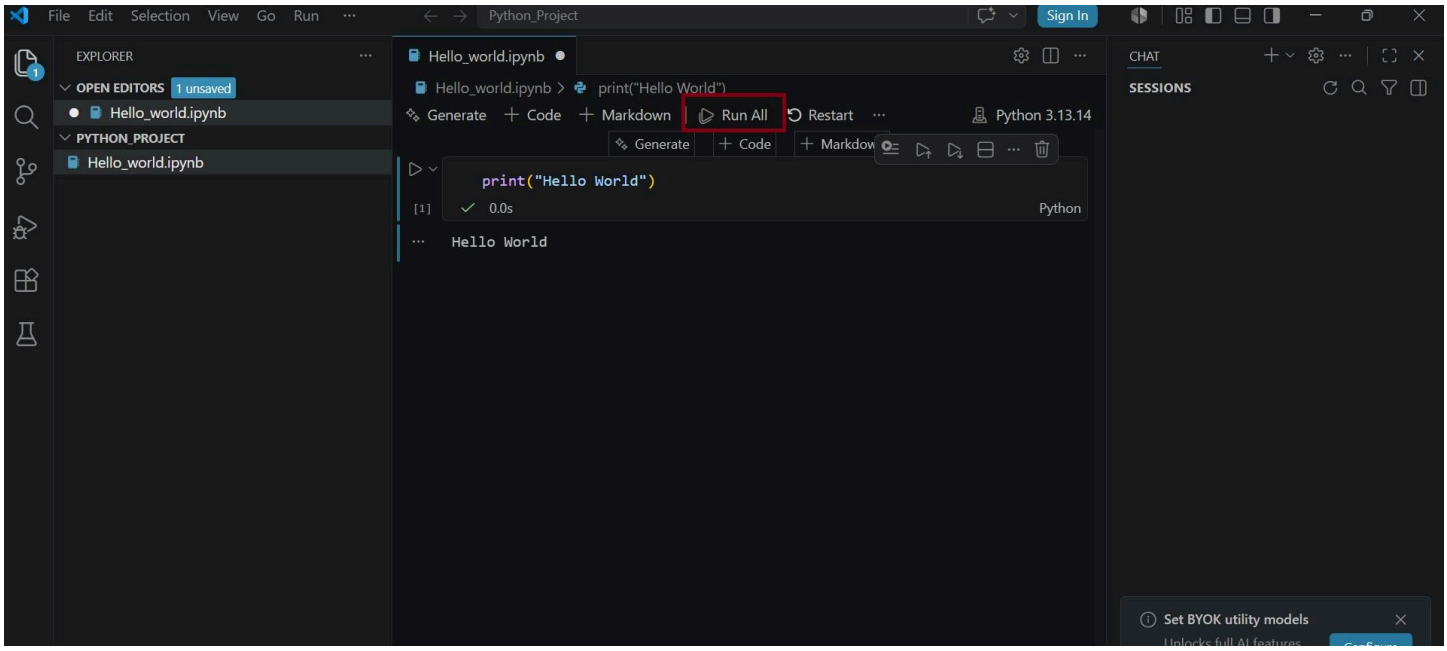


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14. Click on **"+Code" .** A cell will be generated.

15. Type the following command: print("Hello World") and click on **"Run All"**

16. The following program will run and output will be generated:

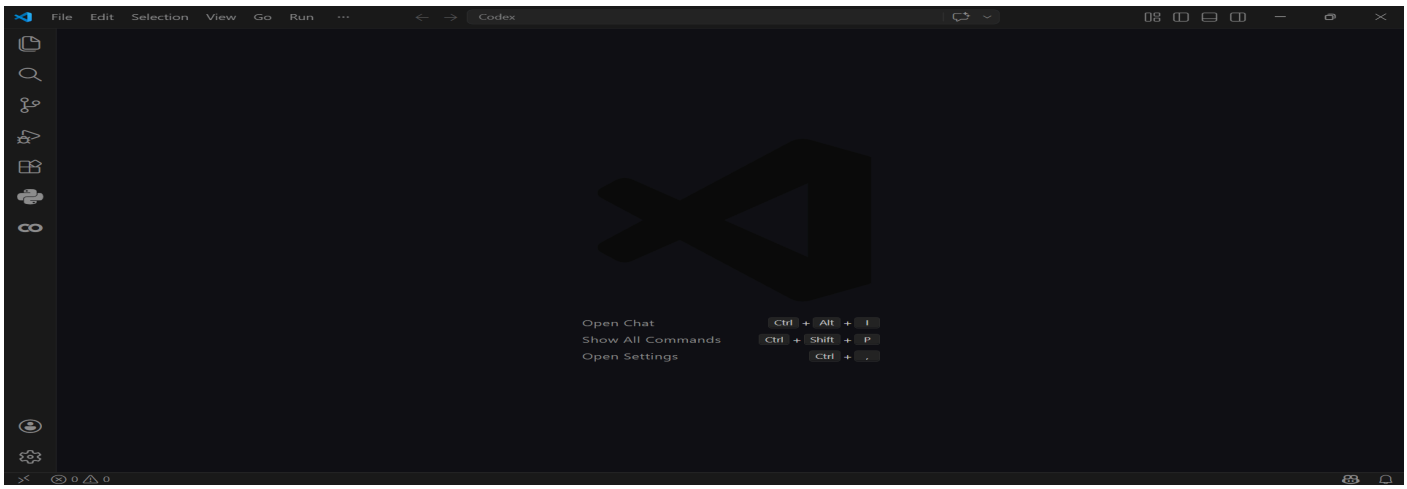


17. This indicates you have successfully installed the Python packages and are ready to code.

Note: In case, if you click on run and you get a pop-up stating the Python package needs to be installed, then click on install.

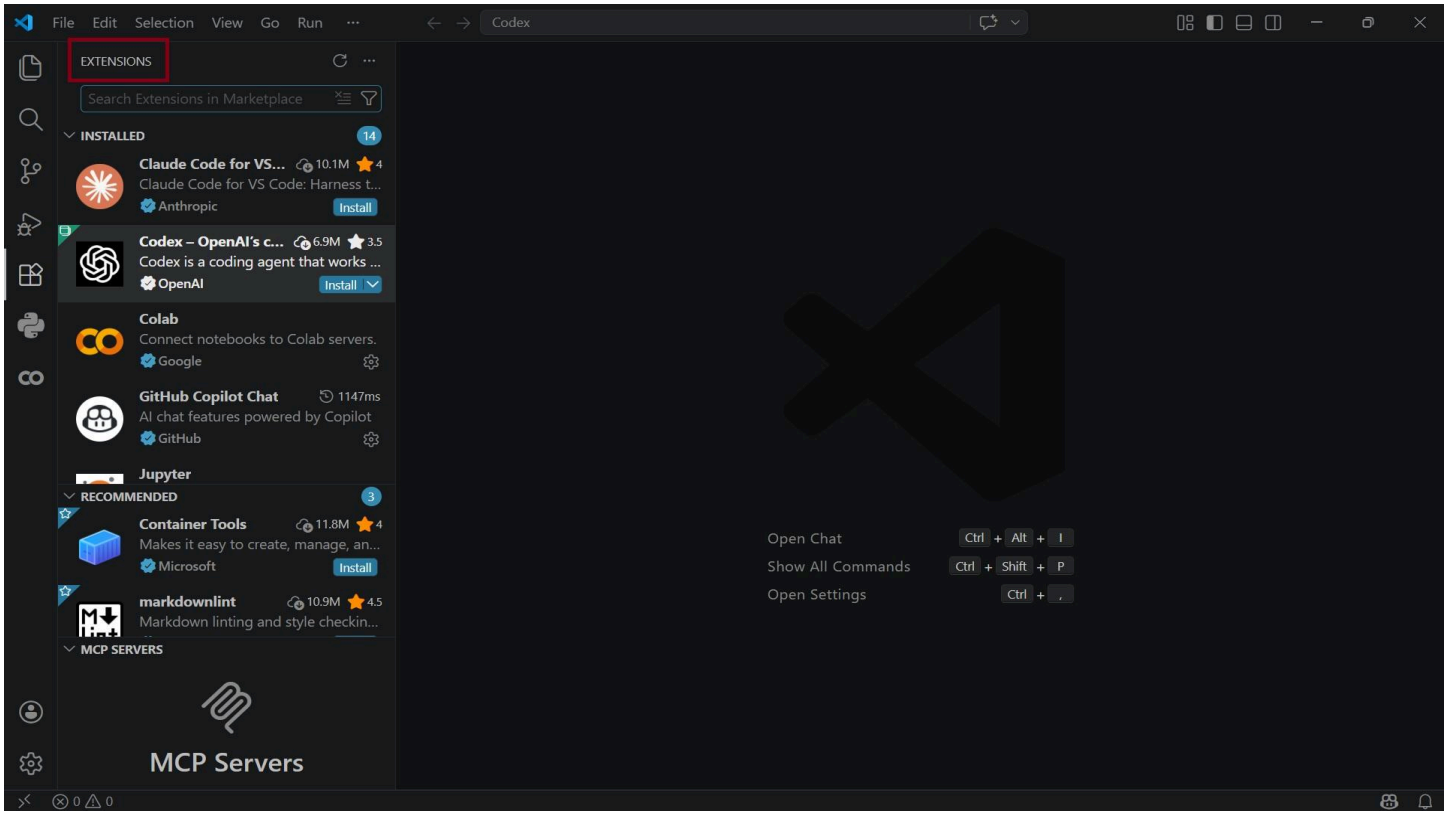
Step 8: Getting Setup with Codex

1. Open Visual Studio Code on your system.

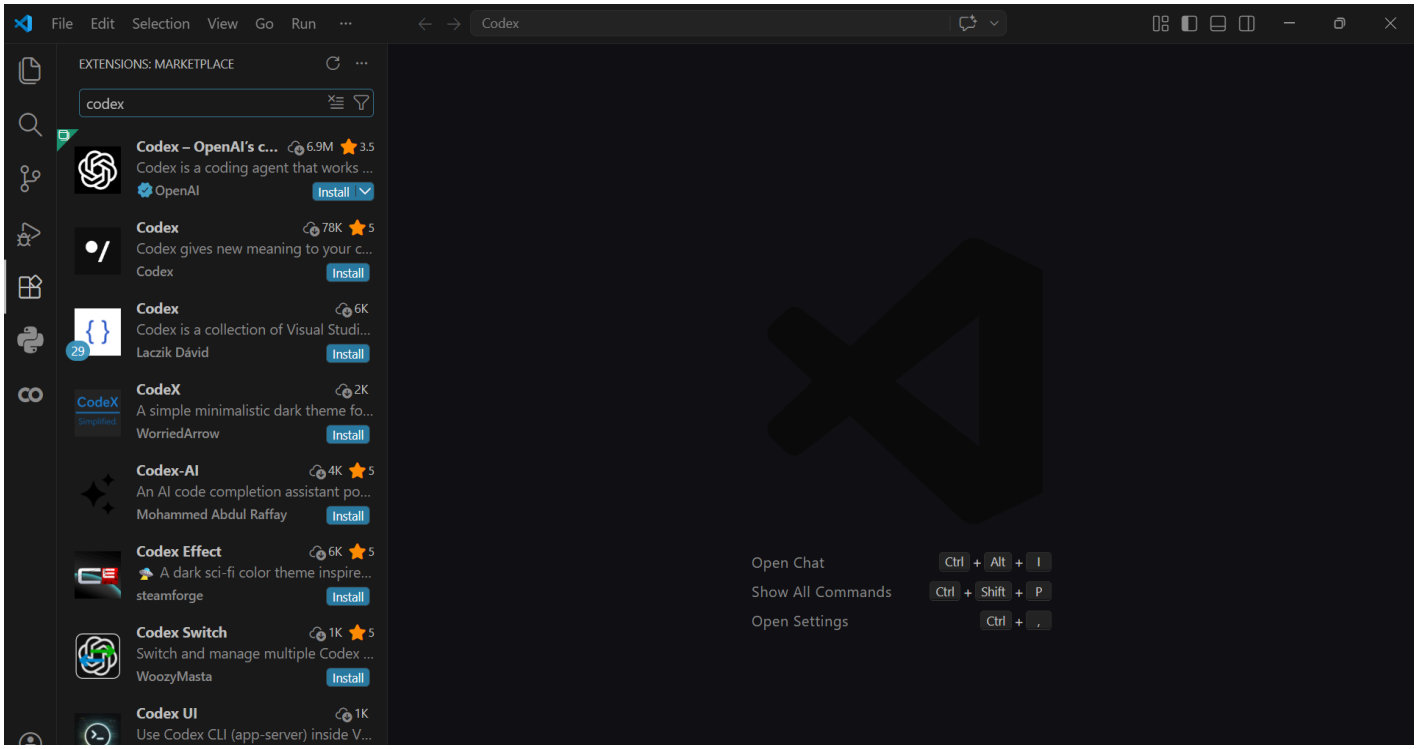


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2. Navigate to the Extensions panel by clicking on the Extensions icon in the left sidebar (typically the fifth icon).

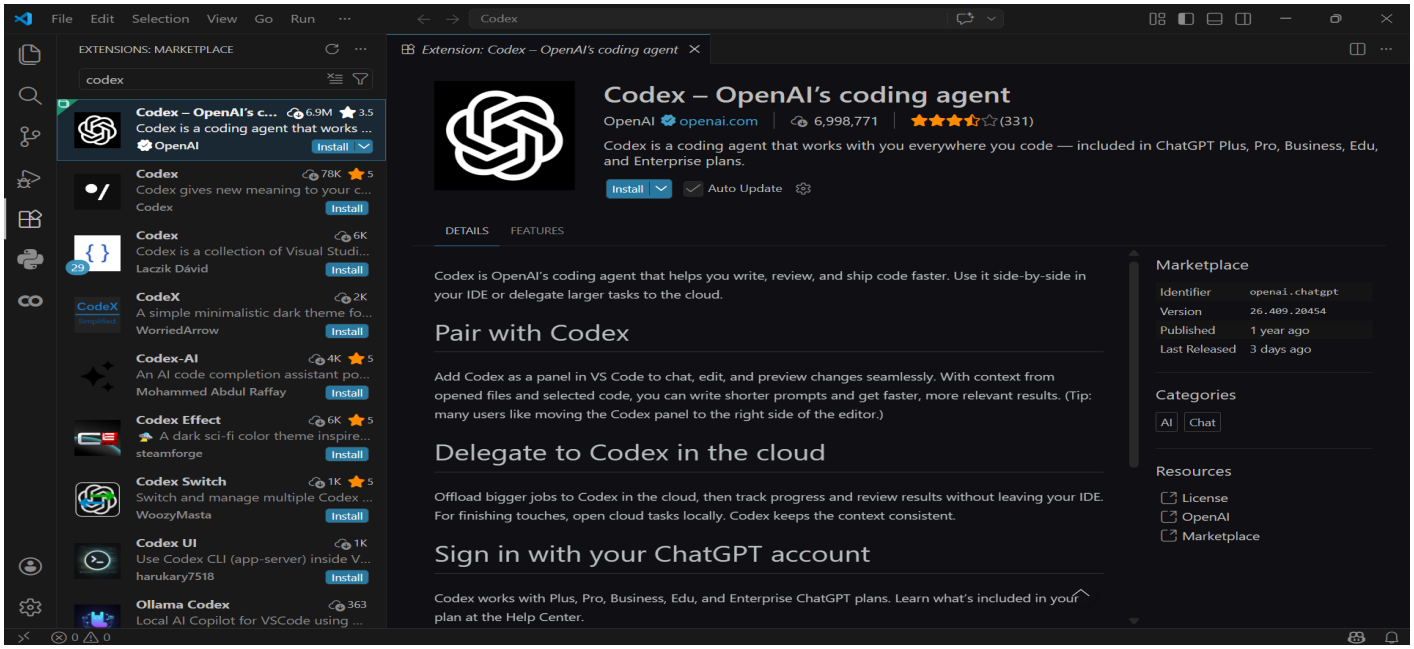


3. In the search bar, type “Codex”.

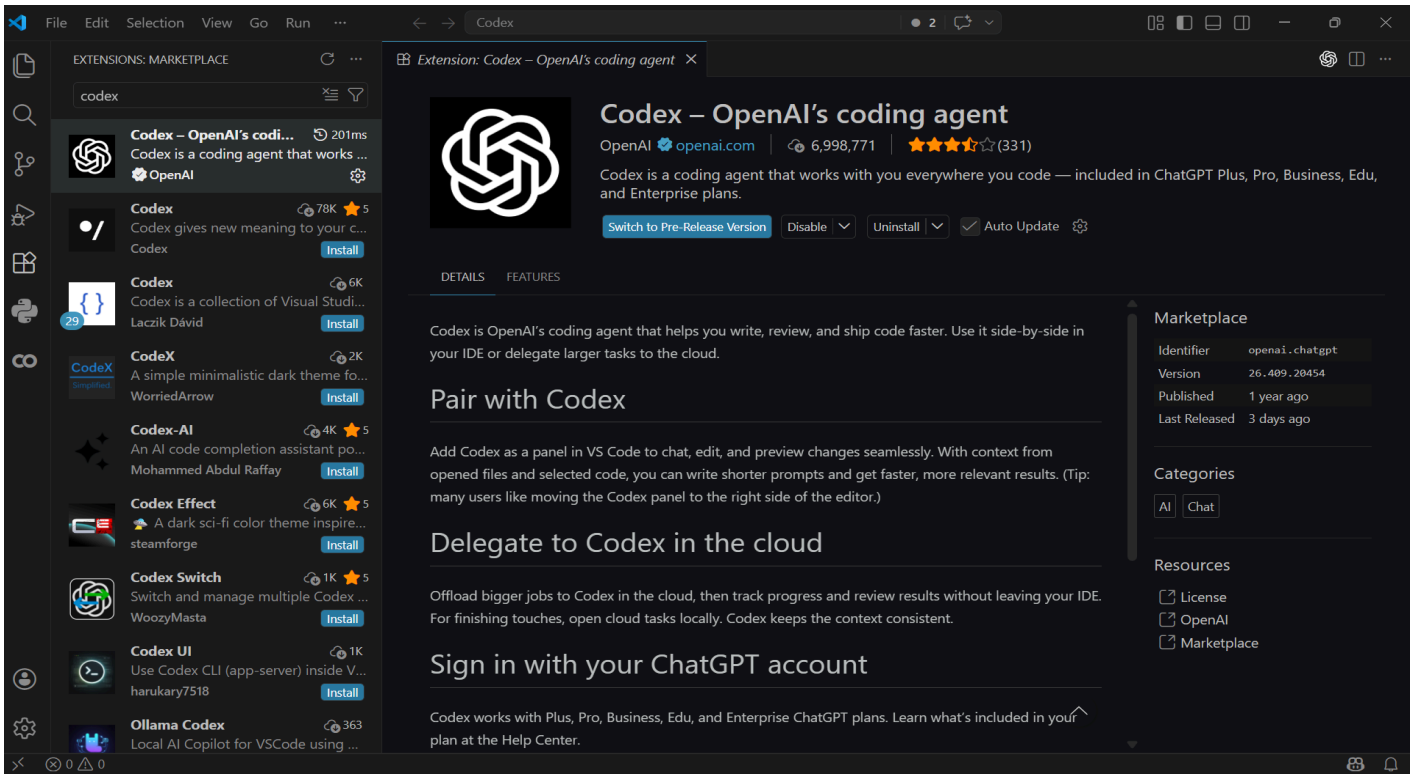


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4. Locate the extension published by OpenAI.

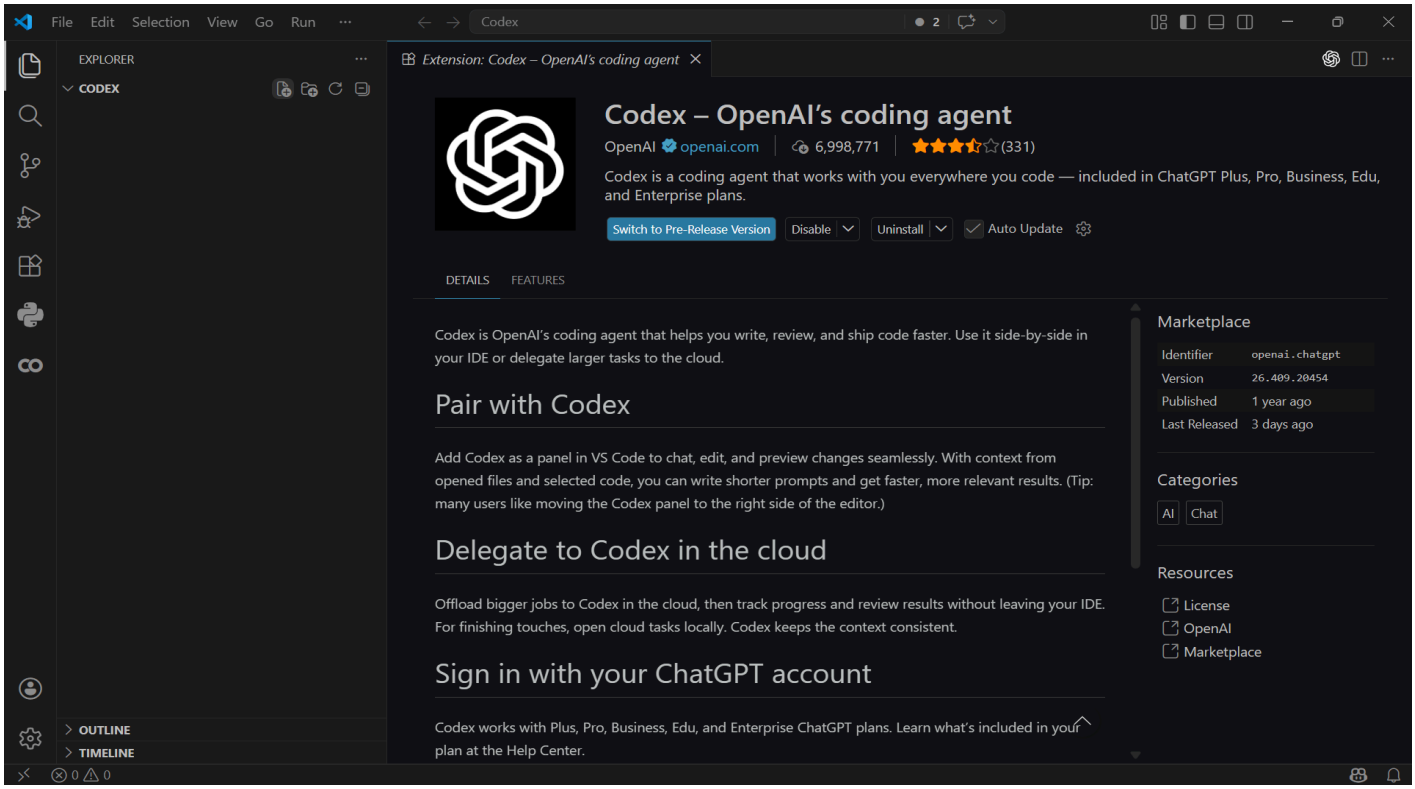


5. Click on the Install button to add the extension.

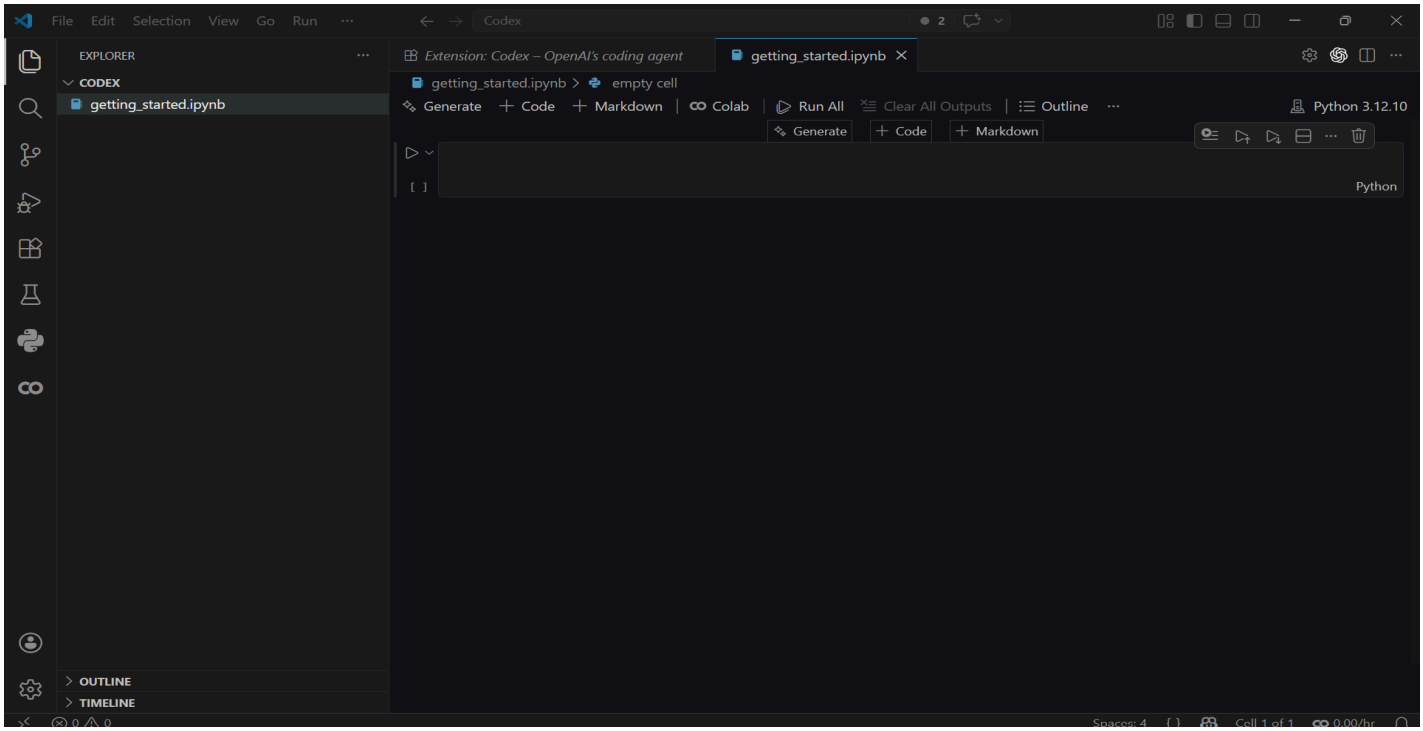


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6. Once installed, ensure the extension is ready to use.

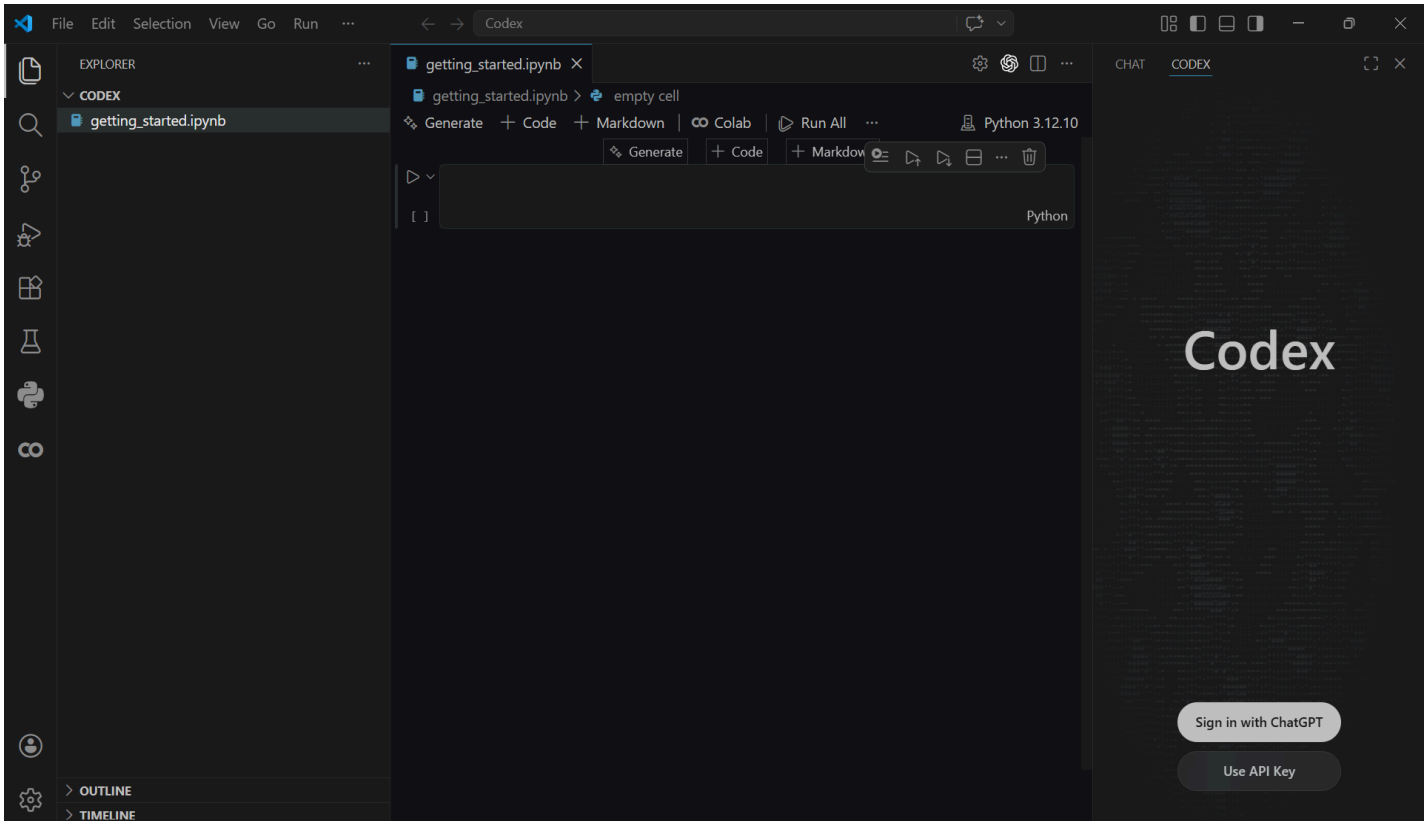


7. Create a new notebook within VS Code.

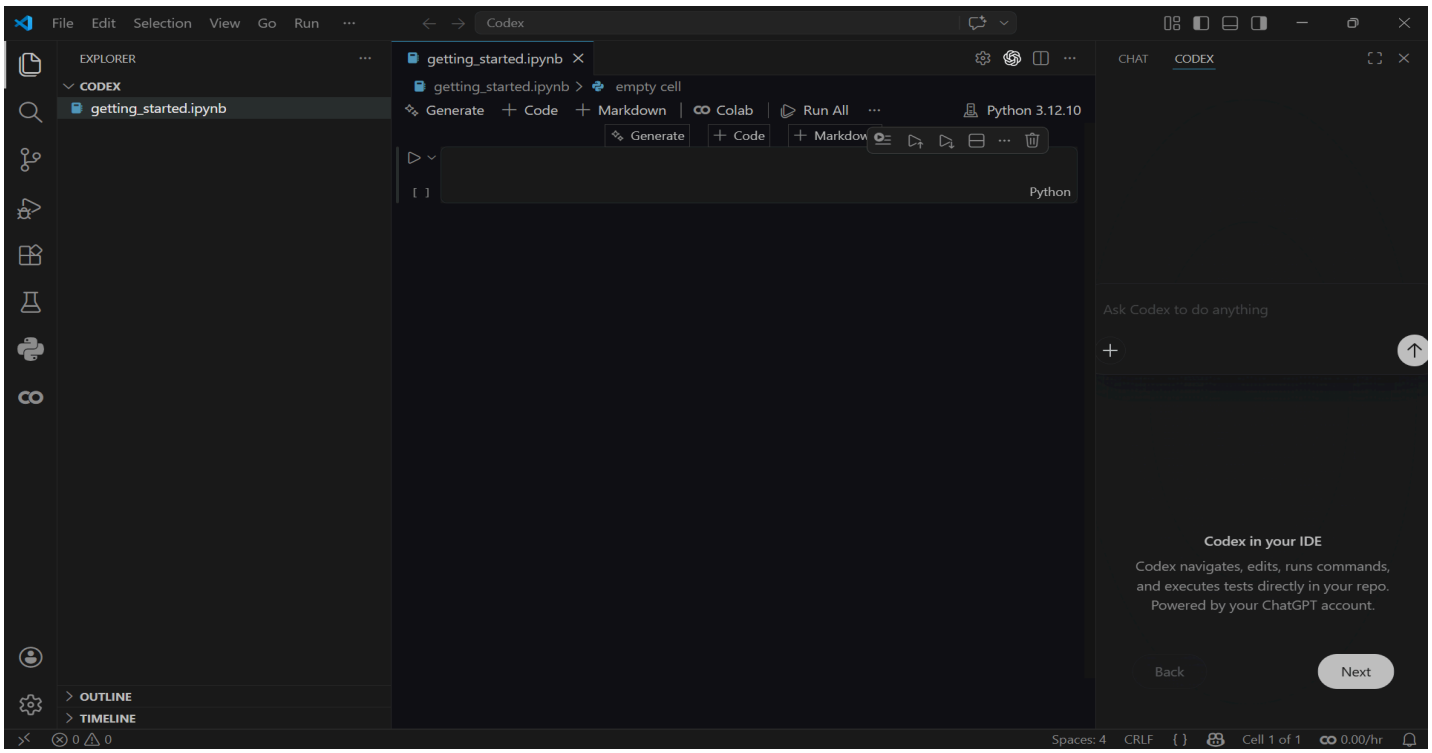


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8. In the top-right corner, click on the ChatGPT/Codex icon. This will open the Codex panel. Then, select “Sign in with ChatGPT” and complete the authentication process.

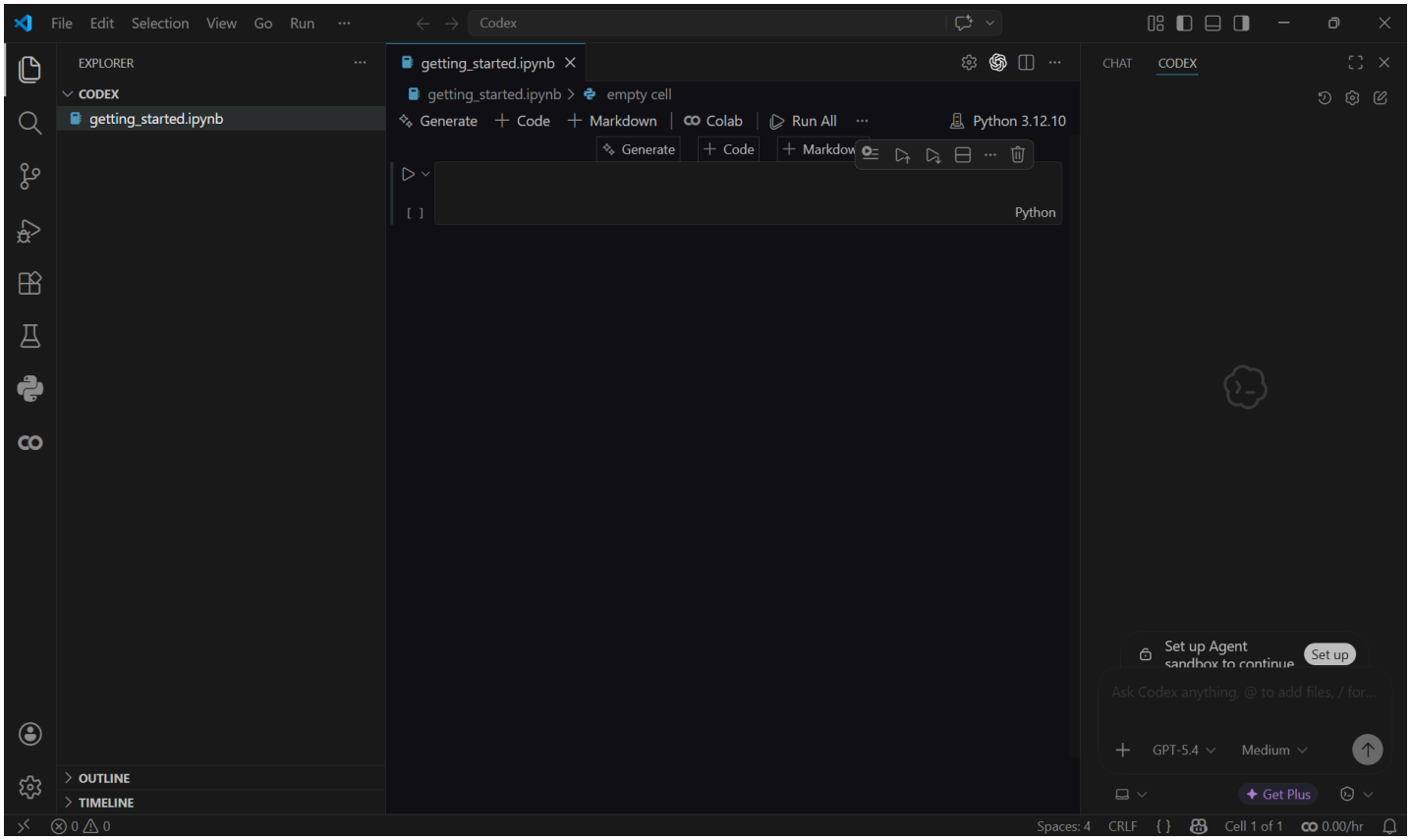


9. Click Next through the setup prompts until you reach the configuration stage.

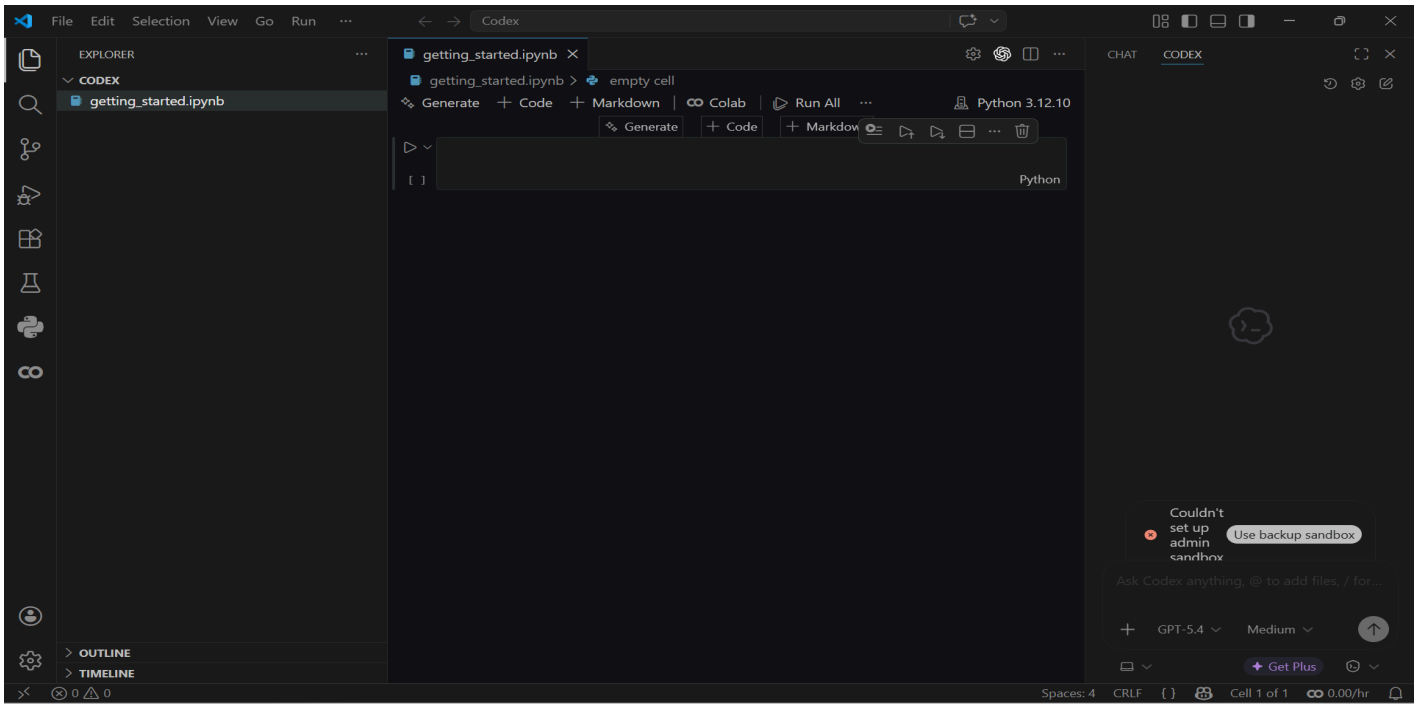


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10. Click on Set Up to configure the sandbox environment, which allows code to run securely.

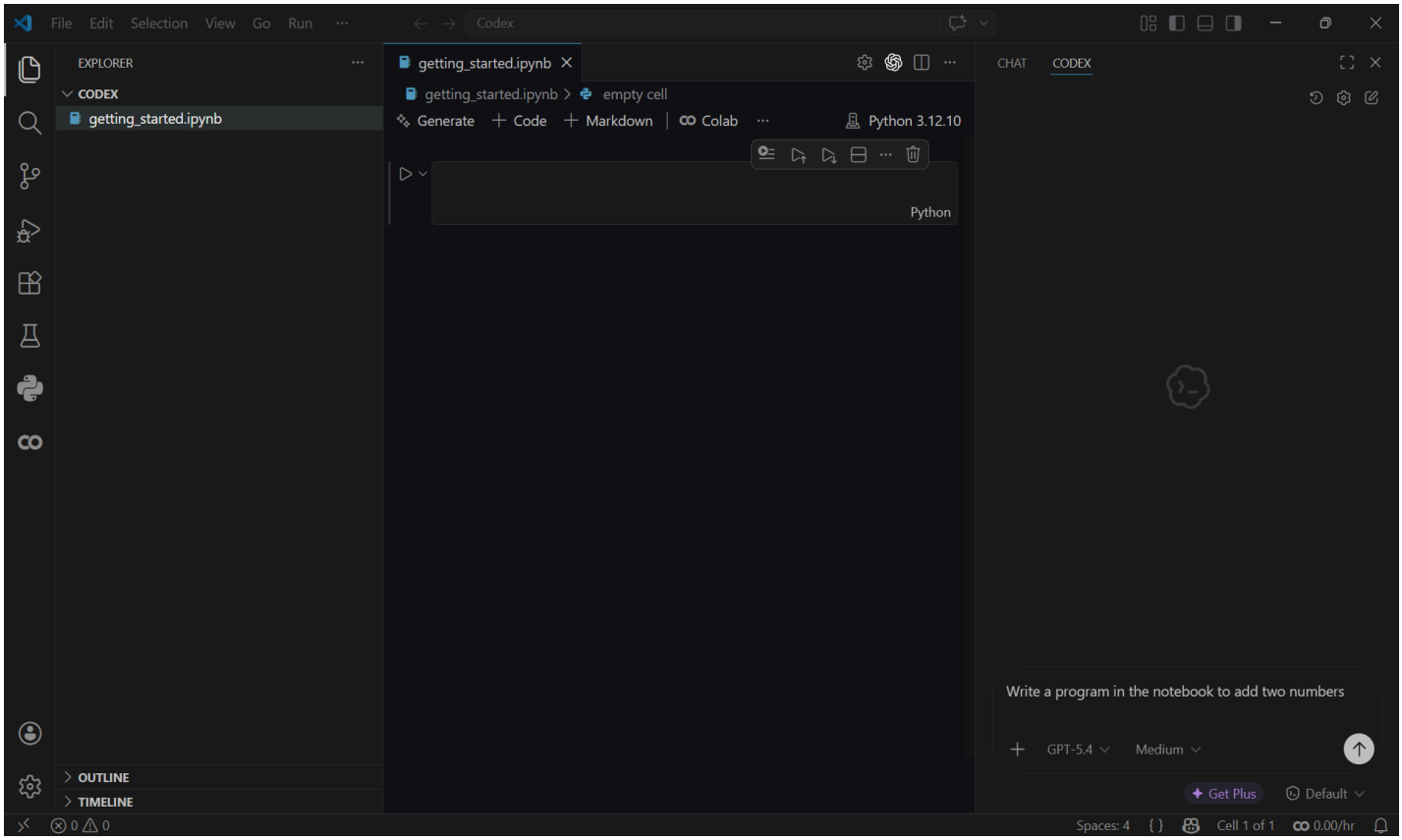


11. If the primary setup is restricted (e.g., due to admin permissions), configure a backup sandbox environment instead.

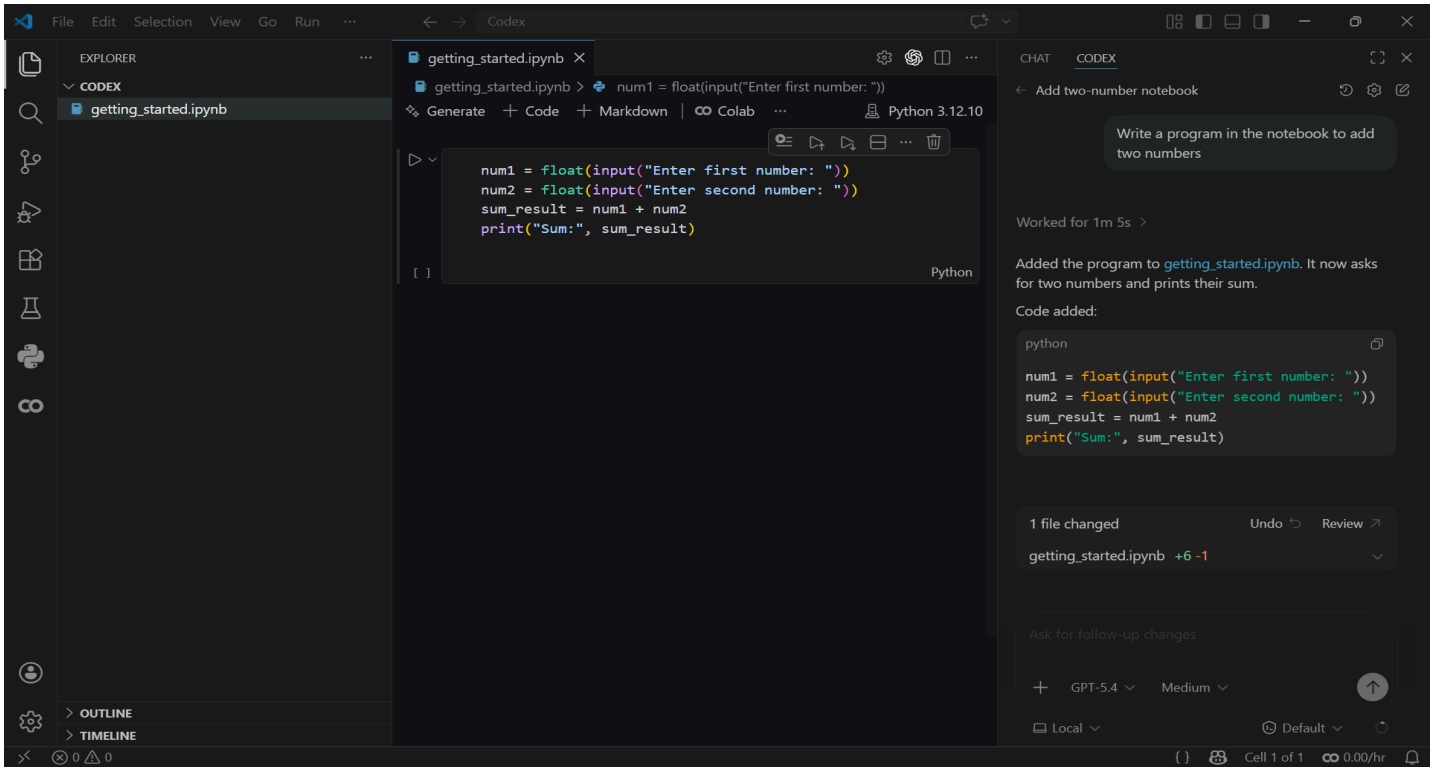


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12. You are now ready to begin - enter your prompt in the Codex panel and click Send.



13. Once the AI processes your request, the output will be displayed directly in the notebook.



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